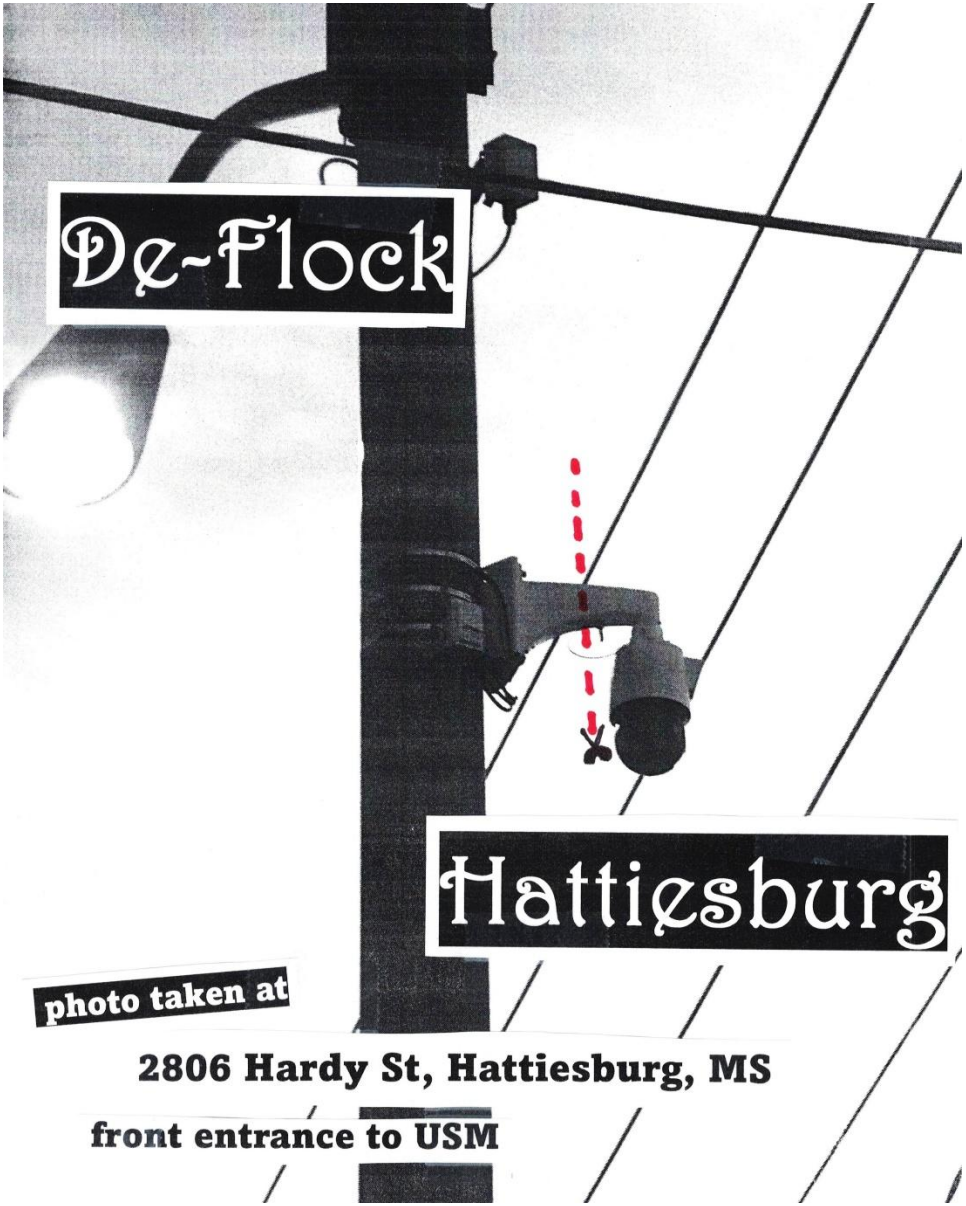


by Davy Goldsmith

Fall 2026

hattiesburg-alt.neocities.org

Let me tell you about Flock Safety Cameras

Maybe you've seen these cameras popping up around town.

They look like this:



or sometimes like this:



or sometimes even like this!



more information
on Flock products

In Hattiesburg you can find a bunch driving down Hardy Street, at Lowes and Home Depot, and around entrances USM and William Carey.

To get a better idea of where Flock cameras are anywhere in the U.S, go to deflock.org or you can download the app:

THE BIG DEAL

Flock and artificial intelligence (AI) tracking cameras are different than normal security cameras in that they use AI to record data on time, location, and identifying information about each vehicle or person who travels past them in public or private spaces. Their cameras send data wirelessly to private servers held in private data centers that are not inherently accessible to public or governmental entities. Access to their data is then purchased using federal grant money by local offices, like Forrest County!

Through a public records request, I was able to discover that Forrest County supervisors voted last year to approve the installation of 10 Flock cameras and the software used to access the data they constantly collect on every day folks like you and me and everyone who passes by a camera, knowing or not knowing! Just these 10 cameras cost the federal government and tax payers $42,500.

Through this public records request, I also got a hold of the legal agreement our county Sheriff, Charles Sims signed with Flock. This agreement or Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) gives Flock total control over the data they collect and profit from. They even have provisions in the MOU where they list several scenarios in which they can legally suspend service to the sheriff. This data is stored on their own private servers in their own private data

centers and access to them is sold to back to the sheriff, but not exclusively. Flock is at total liberty to sell or share this data with anyone else they'd want at their sole discretion.

Security cameras are supposed to be owned by the people who pay for them, and the data they collect is supposed to be owned and held locally and temporarily. But Flock and AI tracking cameras don't do this!

The county didn't buy security cameras.

The county only bought non-exclusive access to the data Flock collects and approved their installation. Flock is paid with federal tax dollars to install cameras that spy on you and collect information on your appearance, time and location, and direction of travel. Then, they can sell or share that data, collected by AI to anyone without your consent or knowledge.

Sheriff Sims didn't know.

He didn't know what was in the legal agreement he signed when I reached out to him in an email exchange after reading the MOU. Despite signing this agreement himself, Sheriff Sims was unaware of these conditions and cited other, contradictory and non-superseding information from Flock's website.

Sheriff Sims is currently waiting to hear from Flock on what they have to say about what I'm claiming, but what I'm telling you is backed up by their own legally binding agreement between the county and Flock. Sheriff Sims also made a pledge to me to personally take them down if he thought what I claim is true, which I backed up, using the agreement he signed.

“We have not installed any flock cameras in the city”

according to Mayor Toby Barker as stated in a TikTok comment earlier this month of September.



While the statement could be technically accurate if the city has not signed a contract with Flock, it steps around the truth that Flock cameras are already present in Hattiesburg and that there’s a standing legal agreement for Forrest County.

Someone put these cameras here, and it doesn’t really matter who. It just matters what our public officials do about it.

We’re generally aware that crowd-sourced maps and information may not be 100% accurate, but deflock.org is one of the only accessible places for information on AI surveillance cameras. And it does a better job at revealing the truth: your right to privacy is not respected on the roadway.

Your ability to get useful information on AI surveillance cameras is important and so is your opinion and your ability to voice it.

What do we expect?

We expect competence from our elected officials.

We expect them to do the research to understand how Flock and AI tracking cameras work and why they're so publicly hated *before* they approve their installation.

We expect them to communicate with each other and share information on at least the existence of Flock and AI tracking cameras in the city and county they serve.

What do we demand?

We demand that this contract be terminated and the Flock cameras come down. Flock isn't going to take them down themselves, so it has to be the city or county. At least bag or cover them up.

We demand that any city or county contract involving security cameras gives ownership of the physical cameras and the data they collect to be stored, monitored, and maintained locally in publicly owned servers and centers by public employees subject to the policies, oversight, regulation, and transparency required as such.

We demand more than policy changes. We want a law prohibiting AI tracking cameras. We want our politicians to get ahead of this technology and do the right thing to protect our constitutional right to privacy.

We demand that Flock delete the data they've already collected.

We demand an apology from our elected officials. Say you're sorry for not notifying people about these cameras, for not reading the contract, and for not trusting your eyes when you saw them.

What should we do?

Let's start off my reaching out to our elected officials to let them know how we feel and what we want them to do.

Here's a calling or email script for you to go by:

Hi my name is _____, and I'm calling as a concerned resident of Hattiesburg about the Flock Safety Cameras popping up around town. Do you have a moment to talk about them? I promise to keep it quick.

We've become aware of an agreement made by the Forrest County Sheriff and approved by the Board of Supervisors to install at least 10 Flock AI tracking cameras throughout Forrest County.

Flock and other AI tracking cameras are different than normal security cameras in that they use artificial intelligence to record data on time, location, and identifying information about each vehicle or person who travels past them in public or private spaces. These cameras and data are privately owned by Flock who retains the legal right to share this data with anyone at their choosing at their sole discretion.

I'm calling on you to do what you can and to vote however you must to get these cameras removed and to restore trust in our community. We demand the privacy guaranteed to us by the constitution. Thank you and I'll remember how you represent us.

Here's the public contact information for the 5 Forrest County supervisors who unanimously approved the cameras:

<u>DISTRICT 1</u> Gentry Mordica

gmordica@forrestcountyms.us

(601) 545 6091

DISTRICT 2

Sharon Thompson

sthompson@forrestcountyms.us

(601) 545 6010

DISTRICT 3

Steve Stringer

sstringer@forrestcountyms.us

(601) 545 6008

DISTRICT 4

Roderick “Rod” Woullard, Vice President

rwoullard@forrestcountyms.us

(601) 545 6011

DISTRICT 5

Terri Bell, President

tbell@forrestcountyms.us

(601) 545 6009

Here’s the public contact information for the Forrest County Sheriff, Charles Sims, who signed the agreement with Flock:

csims@forrestcountyms.us

601-544-7800, Ext 258

Here’s the contact information for the City Council

Ward 1

Jeffrey George

jrgeorge@hattiesburgms.com

Ward 2

Eric Boney

eboney@hattiesburgms.com

Ward 3

LeAnn Vance

lvance@hattiesburgms.com

Ward 4

Dave Ware

dware@hattiesburgms.com

Ward 5

Nicholas Brown

nbrown@hattiesburgms.com

Here's the contact for mayor Toby Barker:

mayor@hattiesburgms.com

601-545-4501

Here's the maps to find your Mississippi State Senators and Representatives and contact them:

Here's the contact information for Governor Tate Reeves:

governor@govreeves.ms.gov

601-359-3150

The governor has more authority on Flock and AI tracking cameras than you may realize. In August, Florida's governor, through his authority over the department of transportation, banned Flock and AI tracking cameras from state roads and effectively terminating contracts made by local law enforcement.

Here's the contact information on US Senators for Mississippi:

Roger Wicker

(202) 224-6253

Cindy Hyde-Smith

(202) 224-5054

Here's the contact information on Hattiesburg's District 4 US Representative:

Mike Ezell

(202) 225-5772

We can also start going to public County Supervisor board meetings and City Council meetings to voice our concerns publicly while addressing them together.

Here's the schedule for Hattiesburg's City Council meetings.

The Hattiesburg City Council meets every 1st and 3rd Monday/Tuesday of the month. Monday meetings take place at 4 p.m. and Tuesday meetings take place at 5 p.m. They meet at City Hall in downtown Hattiesburg, 200 Forrest St, Hattiesburg, MS 39401. See the calendar.

Here's the schedule for Forrest County Board of Supervisor meetings:

The Forrest County Board of Supervisors meets every 1st and 3rd Monday at 10am at the Paul B. Johnson Chancery Building in downtown Hattiesburg, 641 Main St, Hattiesburg, MS 39401. See their calendar.

A couple of last things:

Axon

There are more brands of artificial intelligence (AI) tracking cameras besides Flock that are out there. Another known brand is Axon. They sell similar services that use AI to scan the public to collect data to market to customers. What's important is that we don't stop with Flock and we make sure any laws passed or court rulings are broad enough to encompass bans and regulations on all brands of AI tracking cameras.

Artificial Intelligence

Use of AI is becoming more common and encouraged for daily use over a broad range of industry and tasks. Outsourcing our writing, decision making, and art is undermining our voice, presence, and cognitive functionality. The data it collects to function takes up increasingly more server space, raising the quantity and size of data centers that are expanding all over our country. These data centers require hundreds of thousands of square feet and enough clean water and energy to power our largest cities several times over. When energy is not immediately available, gas generators are built which emit the toxic fumes and noise pollution all gas generators release and make neighboring communities uninhabitable. Besides, the information it records for law enforcement is not consistently accurate, the art it makes is empty, and the writing is terrible. Not to mention that AI developers recently claimed that AI "could kill us all."

Direct Action

You might be thinking to yourself, "Is this all I can do?" All I can say to you is that we don't write about direct action and we don't post about it on social media. Be smart and assess risk and remember to assert you efforts where it's most effective.

Thanks!

Thanks for reading this zine. I hope you feel ready to get and stay involved in local, state, and national politics. Remember that resistance to oppression is always justified and that speaking up for yourself and for the people who need it is good for you! It trains your nervous system and your mind to think for itself and to build up confidence to not shut down at the most crucial times.

I hope

I hope our efforts to ban and regulate AI tracking cameras have a positive effect on our community and help us maintain our autonomy, right to privacy, and restore trust.

Contact me:

Davy Goldsmith

dwgoldsmith3@proton.me